

Dzung Nguyen

Game Designer | Design Manager

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Profile

- Game Designer with experience in gameplay, systems, and narrative
- Design Manager with experience mentoring and leading designers across shipped, live-service, and in-development titles

Shipped and Live Titles

- **Project Makeover** - Magic Tavern
 - Design Manager
 - Lead/Senior Narrative Designer
 - Narrative Designer
- **Realm Defense** - Babeltime Inc.
 - Technical Game Designer

Leadership Skills

- ★ Multidisciplinary Design Management
- ★ Mentorship and Career Development
- ★ Performance Feedback and Growth

Game Design Skills

- ★ Gameplay & System Design
- ★ Narrative Design & Writing
- ★ Live Service Operations
- ★ Rapid Prototyping and Playtesting for new games and features

Technical Skills

- ★ Unity/C#
- ★ Lua
- ★ React, Redux, Firebase
- ★ Jira, Trello, Asana

Game Design Experience

Design Manager | Magic Tavern | April 2024 - Present

- Lead and mentor a multidisciplinary design team of 11 designers and writers across multiple live and in-development titles
- Provide performance feedback, career development guidance, and design critique
- Collaborate with Product, Engineering, Art, and Production leadership to define feature scope, assess timelines, and allocate team resources efficiently
- Streamline collaboration between global teams by resolving blockers, identifying risks, maintaining delivery timelines, and ensuring consistent creative output
- Drive the design of gameplay features, storylines, and dialogue for new projects

Senior Narrative Designer | Magic Tavern | April 2022 - April 2024

- Lead narrative designer on the mobile game Project Makeover
- Coordinate with design, art, and production for makeover content from conception to release
- Led designers and writers through planning, task assignment, and quality reviews
- Propose and plan episode releases, limited time makeovers, and events to improve engagement and retention
- Partnered with international development teams to coordinate creative direction, feature requirements, and production priorities

Narrative Designer | Magic Tavern | July 2020 - April 2022

- Designed player-facing content and progression experiences for the live-service mobile game Project Makeover pre and post-launch
- Designed narrative specs and stories, direct character animation, and play test new builds to ensure the highest quality is achieved
- Designed and shipped over 30 makeover episodes from conception to release
- Collaborated with global teams across varying disciplines to design and release exciting creative content for players
- Gathered and assessed player feedback to iterate and improve on design structure and content

Technical Game Designer | Babeltime Inc | February 2017 - November 2018

Education

2012:

Bachelor of Science in Computer
Science

San Jose State University

- Designed and developed gameplay features and systems for the mobile title Realm defense using Unity, C#, and Lua
- Designed tower defense maps across varying worlds and themes
- Increased overall DAU by creating daily content for players including rotational tournament maps and new gameplay modes
- Improved the quality of developed features and new releases by analyzing player behavior data and community feedback

Additional Technical Experience

Co-founder & CTO | Brinkfolio | July 2022 - February 2023

- Co-founded, designed, developed, and launched a visual portfolio web product
- Learned and utilized React, Reflux, and Firebase within two months to create the product
- Converted user feedback into product and usability improvements post-launch

Technical Support Representative | Visa | August 2019 - July 2020

- Engage with clients through multiple channels to creatively resolve technical issues with their integration
- Cross-functional communication with global teams to both develop and refine internal workflow processes
- Develop and improve technical documents for both internal and external use

Back-end Web Developer | Perfect World Entertainment | June 2014 - July 2016

- Developed back-end APIs using PHP, MySQL, and JavaScript for both user websites and billing portals through full development cycles
- Developed game promotions by creating scripts using PHP and MySQL to increase user engagement and user spending by 20% during holiday events
- Cross-functional work with various departments to discuss feature development, task breakdowns, and scope
- Developed the Arc Account Balance system using PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, creating a wallet for thousands of users to receive refunds and spend money on in-game products

Technical Support | Perfect World Entertainment | May 2012 - June 2014

- Utilized CRM tools (RightNow and internal tools) to manage customer information and resolve technical issues from an average of 300 players daily
- Organized a technical support forum to funnel all technical issues for over 12 games into one area providing clear team focus for improvements